The Last Testament: A Memoir by God

By David Javerbaum

(Pg 217) Imagine being in fourth grade; the bell for homeroom rings, thou takest thy seat, and suddenly a deafening voice booms from the PA system:

"Good morning, students. I am the LORD thy God, King of the Universe. Here are the announcements: Starting today, I will no longer be accepting any prayers addressed to me from this public school. The Supreme Court hath ruled such prayers violate the First Amendment's establishment clause; and their ruling applies to not only thee, but me. Please refrain from addressing or thinking of me at any time while on school grounds. Also, the chess club will be meeting in Mrs. Binder's classroom during sixth period. Siiiiiixth peeeeeriod!"

Followed by thunder and lightning effects, and hundreds of plastic spiders falling from the ceiling.

Ah . . . one of these days I shall go to an elementary school and do that!

INTRODUCTION

Over the course of his long and distinguished career, God has literally seen it all. And not just seen. In fact, the multi-talented deity has played a pivotal role in many major events, including the Creation of the universe, the entirety of world history, the life of every human being who has ever lived, and the transition to on-line learning during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Now, God breaks his 1,400-year literary silence to answer questions that have plagued mankind for centuries: Does God answer prayers? What is the truth behind all those Unsolved Mysteries on Netflix? Does God Love America the most?

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(Pg 217-219) I can afford to take the banning of school prayer lightly; it is not as if I need another venue wherein to hear thy supplications. For thine is the Golden Age of Prayer; never before have I received so many pleas, from so many people, for so many reasons, accompanied by so many helpful suggestions.

Do I answer them? I shall get to that.

But first, let me provide an overview of prayer, for its very definition is a matter of debate.

For me, prayer is like unto a suggestion box that receives 200,000 suggestions a second. Or an emergency services switchboard manned by one operator who gets 12 million calls a minute.

[Now] I do not regard the human phenomenon of prayer cynically; I am merely trying to describe what it feels like to be incessantly nagged, pestered, and reminded of things I already knew.

It is one thing to ask, "Please take care of Bobby in his time of need"; that is an expression of a well-meaning wish. But it is another entirely to say, "Please take care of Bobby in his time of need; he just broke his leg skiing, and the karate meet is in three weeks and he's been training so hard ... " Heed me: I am the LORD thy God, King of the Universe: I ***know*** Bobby broke his leg skiing, and I ***know*** about the damned karate meet.

(Pg 220) By far my favorite prayer is the Serenity Prayer: "The serenity to accept what cannot be changed; the courage to change what can; and the wisdom to know the difference – these are wise life principles that should be known and followed by **everyone**.

As for my least favorite? That would be the old childhood lullaby: "Now I lay me down to sleep. I pray thee, LORD my soul to keep. And if I die before I wake, I pray thee, LORD, my soul to take."

Even I consider it bizarre, that the last words on children's lips before they go to sleep would address the prospect of their own premature death. They are ***children***. They should be asking me for ***ponies***. In fact, I make unto them this deal: the next one of you who asks for a pony instead of for me to take his or her soul, **gets the pony**.

(Pg 222) So, I know what thou art thinking: Do I answer thy prayers? I [can] assure my flock that every single prayer of thine is ***processed***.

What is the truth behind all those Unsolved Mysteries on Netflix?

(Pg 144-148) I will start with a big one: the identity of the most notorious serial killer of all time, Jack the Ripper.

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It was Neville Hopkins. He was an itinerant pickpocket squatting in Whitechapel; a quiet man; kept to himself; bit of a loner; few close friends. Flew completely under the radar. Right after the final murder he boarded a boat bound for New York and was never heard from again. Anyway, Neville Hopkins: Jack the Ripper. Now thou knowest.

Sticking with unsolved murders, Los Angeles's infamous Black Dahlia murder of 1947 was committed by folk singer Woody Guthrie. In fact, he confessed to the crime in the sixth verse of his most famous song: *(sing to the tune of This Land Is Your Land)* "As I was strolling South Norton Avenue, I met a woman, the Black Dahlia. I killed her slowly and bashed her face in. This land was made for you and me." But he was never caught; for ***no one*** ever makes it to the sixth verse of "This Land Is Your Land."

As for Lizzie Borden, she, with an axe, neither gave her mother 40 whacks, nor, having seen what she had done, gave her father 41. No; that August morning, the Bordens fell victim to a serial killer who broke into their house at random, chopped them both to bits, and fled the scene, never to be heard from again. His name?

Neville Hopkins.

The Shroud of Turin was a forgery produced in 1287 by the Turin Shroudmakers' Guild to promote the local shroud-making industry; it succeeded spectacularly.

The works of William Shakespeare were written by none other than legendary British playwright William Shakespeare.

Lee Harvey Oswald acted alone.

Turning now to cryptozoology: The Loch Ness Monster *does* exist; but he is not a monster of flesh and blood, rather the monster of bigotry and intolerance dwelling inside the human heart, which for some reason is then externalized as an imaginary Scottish plesiosaur.

On the other hand, El Chupacabra ***is*** real; he is a monstrous goat-like creature who poses an actual threat to Mexicans, and an even bigger one to Americans; for soon he plans to cross the border, where he will take away jobs from hardworking *American* mythical creatures like the Jersey Devil and Mothman.

On to a few legendary places: Atlantis was a real city on the Aegean island of Santorini that

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was destroyed by a massive volcano 3,600 years ago. It is lost forever; but I must tell thee that even were it not, it would not be worth finding. For Atlantis was a Bronze Age backwater whose imbecilic citizenry passed its time burping, farting, and raping sheep. Their demise was a boon for civilization, but it is with cities as it is with people: dying young and mysteriously can turn any idiot into a legend. (Yea, it was the only half-intelligent thing Jim Morrison ever did in his life.)

On the other hand, the Lost City of Gold, El Dorado, never existed, and it is just as well; for even I shudder to think of the "missionary work" men like Cortez or Pizarro would have practiced on its people once they caught sight of it. My guess is it would have started with flaying, then gone downhill from there.

Area 51 is a regular US military base; and though classified operations do occur there, they have nothing to do with aliens, UFOs, time travel, or anything out of the ordinary. Those ops all happen in Area 63.

And finally, Stonehenge. I have no idea what the hell Stonehenge is.

But I can shed light on a few questions I am guessing none of you thought ever would - or could - be answered. For example: which came first, the chicken or the egg? ***Neither. The rooster came first.***

What is the sound of one hand clapping? ***Very disappointing, for a performer.***

What is to be done? ***It depends.***

When will they ever learn? ***Eventually.***

Are we there yet? ***No.***

TRANSITION

*(Sing the opening stanza of God Bless America)**

(Pg 135-136) Every time I hear “God Bless America,” I get angry. My objections to song and the saying are personal; for Americans asking me for more blessings is like Tahitians asking me for sunnier days. America is amply blessed; copiously blessed; countless are the blessings with which I have blessed America.

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I blessed its land: the richness and variety of its topography, the fertility of its soil, the temperateness of its climate. I blessed it in its indigenous peoples, whose innate love of freedom was evident in their own freedom from heavy artillery, the concept of property or the resistance to smallpox. I blessed America with tobacco farmers of Jamestown, who showed the world that the new "land of opportunity" could bestow success on anybody willing to rely on hard work, the free market, and millions of black slaves growing a death-crop.

I blessed it with millions of immigrants from every nation on earth; mankind in its heaving diversity arrived on its shores, and every ethnicity fought to find its place, and in so doing each one strengthened the character of the nation. Yea, even the Mexicans.

I blessed it with an era where everyone thought of the United States as the good guy; yea, I go way back with America. *(Shakes head sadly)*

(Pg 139) America, allow me to address thee directly for a moment. When thou sentest a man to the moon, it was the most amazing achievement in human history, and Neil Armstrong correctly hailed it as "one giant leap for mankind," meaning the entire human race. And then he went and put an ***American*** flag on it. On the moon.

Thou drivest me crazy, America, yet still I bless thee; despite all they short comings. And I continue to not only bless thee but to love thee, and to do so unhealthily; unhelpfully; in a manner that keeps thee from doing the soul-searching needed to become a better nation.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

KS State Qualifier
MN State Qualifier

****God Bless America – Music and Lyrics***
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qjbMmIXKZmQ